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Childhelp Tennessee — September 2026 Digital Advertising Summary

Reporting period: September 1 – September 30, 2026

Rebuilding Reach After a Leaner August

In August we pulled display volume back and concentrated it on the audiences that were responding best. September was the next step in that plan: with a clearer picture of who engages, we brought reach back up. Display impressions more than doubled, and the number of people clicking through rose again on top of August's level. September also tends to be a settling-in month for families, with school routines restarting, so steady interest through it is a good sign heading into the fall and holiday season, when fostering and adoption often get a second look.

September at a Glance

- Display impressions (the number of times the ads were shown): **115,252**, up from 53,623 in August
- Display clicks: **1,363**, up from 1,297, a 1.18% click-through rate
- Search impressions: **2,022**, up 12% from 1,807
- Search clicks: **119** at a 5.89% click-through rate
- Website visitors who arrived from the ads: **292**, across 344 visits
- Visitors to the Tennessee foster and adoption section: **228**, viewing 323 pages
- Phone taps from ad visitors: **8**
- Facebook and Instagram: 57,661 impressions reaching 8,984 people, with 377 link clicks (a 0.65% click-through rate)

What Stood Out

More reach and more clicks in the same month. Doubling the number of times an ad is shown almost always lowers the share of people who click, because the message is reaching a wider and less pre-qualified audience. That happened here: click-through rate settled at 1.18% after August's unusually concentrated 2.42%. Total clicks still went up, though, and 1.18% remains above the 0.5% to 1.0% range typical for nonprofit display advertising. This is the healthy version of scaling back up: more people reached, more people responding, and efficiency still above the norm.

Search reached more people. Search impressions rose 12%. Clicks eased slightly, from 131 to 119, and click-through rate moved from 7.25% to 5.89%. That sits at the top of the 4% to 6% range typical for nonprofit search. The "Fostering Service" and "Fostering" ad groups led with click-through rates of 6.54% and 6.48%. "Become Foster Parent," the most decided phrasing in the set, kept pace at 6.25% and grew to 304 impressions from 185.

The Tennessee section stayed busy. The ads brought 292 people to the site across 344 visits, and the Tennessee foster and adoption section drew 228 visitors and 323 page views. That section is where the campaign's message turns into practical next steps, so steady traffic there is a good sign. Eight ad visitors tapped to call. No form clicks came through from ad visitors this month. That number has been low and uneven all year, and phone remains the primary way interested families reach out.

How the Channels Worked Together

The two channels do different jobs. **Search** reaches people who are already typing fostering or adoption questions into Google, so it carries the highest intent. **Display** works more like a digital billboard on websites and apps across the Knoxville area. It keeps Childhelp's name in front of families who may not be searching yet but fit the profile of someone who might foster. September's mix (search holding a strong click-through rate while display broadened the audience) is the balance the campaign is built for.

Facebook and Instagram ran at a lighter level this month, with display carrying more of the exposure. The social ads were shown 57,661 times to 8,984 people and drew 377 link clicks, a 0.65% click-through rate, in line with earlier in the summer. Women who had already engaged with Childhelp's page and posts, along with similar lookalike audiences, responded most, with 156 clicks at a 1.07% rate. People resembling recent site visitors clicked at the highest rate of any audience, 1.74%.

Audience and Geography

Knoxville supplied the large majority of display reach with 100,222 impressions, followed by Farragut (4,619), Karns (4,193), Corryton (2,249) and Powell (2,081). Search followed the same pattern, led by Knoxville (1,582), then Farragut (145) and Karns (118).

The display audience skewed toward the 55-64 and 35-44 age groups, which together made up about three-quarters of impressions. As display widened, it also reached slightly more men than women this month. Search, by contrast, reached women more than five to one among people whose gender is known. That's a useful reminder that search reaches the people actively looking, while display casts the wider net.

The Wider Website

Childhelp's national website drew 26,595 visitors and 48,026 page views in September, with average engagement time edging up from 31 to 34 seconds. Nearly all of that traffic is national and unrelated to the Tennessee campaign, so we treat it as background rather than a campaign result. Within it, Knoxville visitors stayed notably engaged, averaging 5.72 interactions per visit, well above the site-wide average of about 4.

Looking Ahead

September showed the campaign can scale back up without losing its footing: display reach doubled, clicks rose, and search and display both stayed above nonprofit norms. Over the coming months we'll keep the broader reach in place while steering display toward the age groups and audiences that respond most strongly, and keep a close eye on Tennessee section visits and phone taps as the clearest signals of real interest. The months ahead lead into the holiday season, which has historically brought renewed attention to fostering and adoption. The campaign is well positioned for it.
